

Muncie Sanitary District February 4, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EqkVl1C4bRk
Publication Date	2026-02-04T16:53:50Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Board of Sanitary Commissioners

Date: February 4, 2026

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners was called to order on February 4, 2026, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board members Mr. Clark, Mr. Overton, Mr. Smith, and the presiding officer/interim district administrator.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Steve Selvi (excused absence).
 - **Presiding Officer:** The interim district administrator (serving as meeting chair).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The board reviewed and approved the minutes from the January 21, 2026 board meeting. *(Approved by Voice Vote)*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:46 Item 1: Award of the Levy Mowing Bid**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Interim District Administrator / Board President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The district received two bids for levy mowing (Smith Family Services and Buffins Landscaping and Snow Removal). In consultation with legal counsel and staff (including Mr. Tom Noble and Chuck), it was determined that the lowest bidder, Buffins, did not possess the specific equipment required to meet FEMA standards for mowing sloped levees, which prevents erosion issues. Therefore, staff recommended awarding the contract to Smith Family Services as the lowest qualified bidder.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Authorized the board president to proceed with the contracting process with Smith Family Services. *(Approved by Voice Vote)*
 - **00:06:06 Item 2: 3800 Block East Wilson Property Purchase**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Interim District Administrator (with input from Jason Datty, Sanitation Superintendent, and Tom Noble).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered purchasing approximately 15 acres of property located south of Centennial Road off Wilson Road for \$182,950. The site will be developed into a leaf and wood composting and mulching facility for the city. Currently, the city pays East Central Recycling approximately \$58 per ton to dispose of leaves in a landfill. The project aims to reduce disposal costs, utilize street sweeper and forestry waste, and eventually provide free compost to the city. Purchase pricing was determined by averaging two professional appraisals in compliance with Indiana state code. The purchase is contingent upon confirming proper zoning and planning permissions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:00:50 Rick Yenser** (during general comment, addressing property acquisition): Expressed concern regarding the acquisition of taxable property into tax-exempt status within a flood zone, and questioned general district spending.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved the property purchase contingent upon due diligence and zoning verification. *(Approved by Voice Vote)*
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:00:50 Rick Yenser:** Addressed the board regarding concerns over acquiring taxable property and making it tax-exempt, inquired about an update on a \$5 million levy project near Philips Pool from the previous fall, and urged the sanitary district to focus on keeping the river clean and picking up trash.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **District Administrator Update:** Work continues at 301 North High Street on the long-term control plan project (CSO 28) by Bowen, with no road closures planned at this time (updates to be posted on the MSD website). The search for a permanent district administrator has been extended for a couple of weeks to gather additional applicants.
 - **Board Recognition:** The board president commended the human resources department—specifically Melanie, Sherry, Rich, and Maggie—for their background work managing health insurance, workers' compensation, and FMLA for city and district employees.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion and voice vote.
(Approved by Voice Vote)
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